NOTE Later I will provide you with a JSON file you can use to load the entire configuration when starting up the Keycloak container, so you won't need to be concerned about the container's persistence.

You can start a Keycloak container by opening a Terminal window, navigating to the folder where you keep the docker-compose.yml file, and running this command:

```
$ docker-compose up -d polar-keycloak
```

Before we can start managing user accounts, we need to define a security realm. We'll do that next.

11.2.1 Defining a security realm

In Keycloak, any security aspect of an application or a system is defined in the context of a *realm*, a logical domain in which we apply specific security policies. By default, Keycloak comes preconfigured with a *Master* realm, but you'll probably want to create a dedicated one for each product you build. Let's create a new *PolarBookshop* realm to host any security-related aspects of the Polar Bookshop system.

Make sure the Keycloak container you started earlier is still running. Then open a Terminal window, and enter a bash console inside the Keycloak container:

```
$ docker exec -it polar-keycloak bash
```

TIP Keycloak might take several seconds to start up. If you try to access it right after starting the container, you might get an error because it's not yet ready to accept connections. If that happens, wait a few seconds and try again. You can check the Keycloak logs with `docker logs -f polar-keycloak`. After the message "Running the server in development mode" is printed out, Keycloak is ready to be used.